Paper structure

On the irrelevance of irrelevant moment conditions

1. Introduction

When a subset of moment inequalities determines the identified set, should a researcher use the remaining inequalities for inference? Introduce the computational reason for seeking a core determining class. Credit Chesher and Rosen (2020, pp. 104–105) for observing that an omitted moment may be estimated more precisely. Pose two questions. When can a test that retains a redundant inequality be uniformly improved? How much power might be lost by keeping or dropping it? Reserve any claim that retention typically costs little for what Section 4 establishes.

Sources. core-determining-classes.pdf, pp. 1–2, gives citation targets, including Galichon–Henry (2011), Pakes–Porter (2024), and Luo–Ponomarev–Wang (2026, p. 25). Verify the design behind Luo–Wang's (2018) reported gain before comparing it with ours.

2. Admissibility in the normal model

2.1 The experiment. Observe $X \sim N_d(\mu, \Omega)$ with known positive-definite correlation matrix. Partition the coordinates into core and redundant sets and impose $\mu_r \leq \max_{c \in \mathcal{C}} \mu_c$ for every redundant r. The core inequalities alone characterize the null $\mu \leq 0$. Define admissibility against all level-α tests, including randomized competitors. Introduce exact-size tests with closed, convex, lower acceptance regions. A contrast test outside this class is strictly dominated by constant randomization (three-dimensional-case, Proposition 5). Use general-case-lessons for exposition and general-case, equations (1)–(4), for the formal setup.

2.2 What the number of core moments changes. Start with the directional derivative of a proposed power improvement. With two or more cores, dominance forces equality of first moments at the origin. With one core it permits a first-order transfer. Introduce feasible support, then show why first-moment equality can protect a region with one additional face. Give the multiple-core consequences (halfspaces, core-only rectangles, adding one redundant face), followed by a short remark on the open two-infeasible-face case. With one core, contrast an admissible positive augmentation with the improvement obtained by replacing a rectangular cutoff with a gate under independence. Both constructions use redundant information. *Sources.* general-case, Lemmas 1 and 6, Definition 3, Propositions 4–5 and 7, Corollaries 8–10, Proposition 11 and Conjecture 12. Number the core-only rectangle corollary from general-case-lessons as the benchmark for Section 4.1.

2.3 Two moments. State the exact characterization as a theorem. For one core and one redundant moment, at every $-1 < \rho < 1$, an exact-size closed, convex, lower acceptance region yields an admissible test if and only if every nonzero normal with finite support value satisfies $0 \leq a_2 \leq a_1$. Use necessity-feasible-normal-general-omega, Theorem 1, p. 2. For sufficiency, the ray criterion was checked against Lehmann–Romano, Theorem and Corollary 6.7.1, pp. 234–235.

2.4 Three moments. Hold the all-three max test and independence fixed and change the allocation. With two cores the rectangle is admissible. With one core a calibrated gate strictly improves it at every alternative. End with these two cases. Section 4 will attach magnitudes to them. Use three-dimensional-case, Propositions 2 and 6.

3. From population inequalities to the normal experiment

Use the nested bounds in Addition.pdf, (3.1). The third bound is redundant if it exceeds or equals the smaller of the first two. For standardized drift h_j and moment standard deviation σ_j, raw redundancy gives

$$\sigma_3 h_3 \leq \max\{\sigma_1 h_1, \sigma_2 h_2\} \ .$$

Positive rescaling preserves signs but can reverse the ordering of violations. Equal marginal variances recover the ordering in Section 2. For the GMS limit, distinguish fixed finite drifts from slackness on the selection scale. Use limit-moment-selection, Propositions 1–2, and Addition.pdf, (3.2) and Theorem 3.1, aligning the sign conventions.

What carries over. In the units in which the mean order holds, any positive-definite covariance Σ preserves the dual-cone dichotomy, the first-moment restriction, the feasible-support results with $\Sigma a \in \Lambda$, Proposition 7 and Corollary 8. Under independence, any positive marginal variances v_j also preserve Corollary 9 and the core-only rectangle result. Proposition 11 uses the recalibrated gate $X_1/v_1 + X_r/v_r$. This covers Section 4's independent design.

Where scale matters. Under the raw order $\mu_2 \leq \mu_1$, take variances $(1, 5)$ and covariance 2. In standardized units $\sigma = (1, \sqrt{5})$, $\rho = 2/\sqrt{5}$, and $\sqrt{5}h_2 \leq h_1$. For every $\varepsilon > 0$ the core-only test strictly dominates the upper-tail test on $X_1 + \varepsilon X_2$ in raw units. The null $(0, -1)$ and alternative $(1, 1)$ establish admissibility of the core-only test by Neyman–Pearson, although its face normal is infeasible at the origin. See unit-diagonal-check-2026-11-05.md for both arguments.

4. Local power under the two core allocations

4.1 Two cores and one redundant inequality. Compare the two-core and all-three max tests (L1 and L2 in Addition.pdf). At $\alpha = .10$, start with independent coordinates and equal variances. For each pair of core signals, show side by side the largest loss from keeping the third inequality and the largest loss from dropping it, in percentage points on a common scale. Highlight core pairs with intermediate short-test power. *To compute.* Use Theorem 3.1 and the exact powers in review-r2d2-first-read-2026-11-05.md.

For the precision comparison, hold the standardized core signals and their scales fixed. The largest cost of keeping is approached as the finite third drift decreases without bound, with all three coordinates retained for calibration. The largest cost of dropping occurs at the upper endpoint allowed by raw redundancy, which depends on σ_3. These are worst losses over the third drift. Any frequency statement also needs explicit weights over alternatives.

4.2 One core. Begin with one redundant inequality. In Addition.pdf, Theorem 2.3 gives gains and losses from retaining it. Under the assumptions of Theorem 2.4, fixing the core drift yields a single crossover as the redundant signal increases. Use Figure 2 to show the sign of the difference and Table 2 (printed p. 21) for its simulated magnitude. Confirm the statistic and level for Table 2, check the crossover assumptions for the chosen statistic, and mark the rows that preserve redundancy.

Then add a second redundant inequality. Compare core-only, the all-three rectangle, and the calibrated gate at a few common alternatives under independence. Proposition 6 of three-dimensional-case establishes the gate's ranking against the rectangle. The magnitudes and the comparison with core-only require new calculations.

Appendix. Collect the Gaussian proofs from notes/ and the local limits from paper/Addition.pdf, Lemmas A.1–A.3. Check their extension to three coordinates. The review memos are in R2-Luke-outputs/.